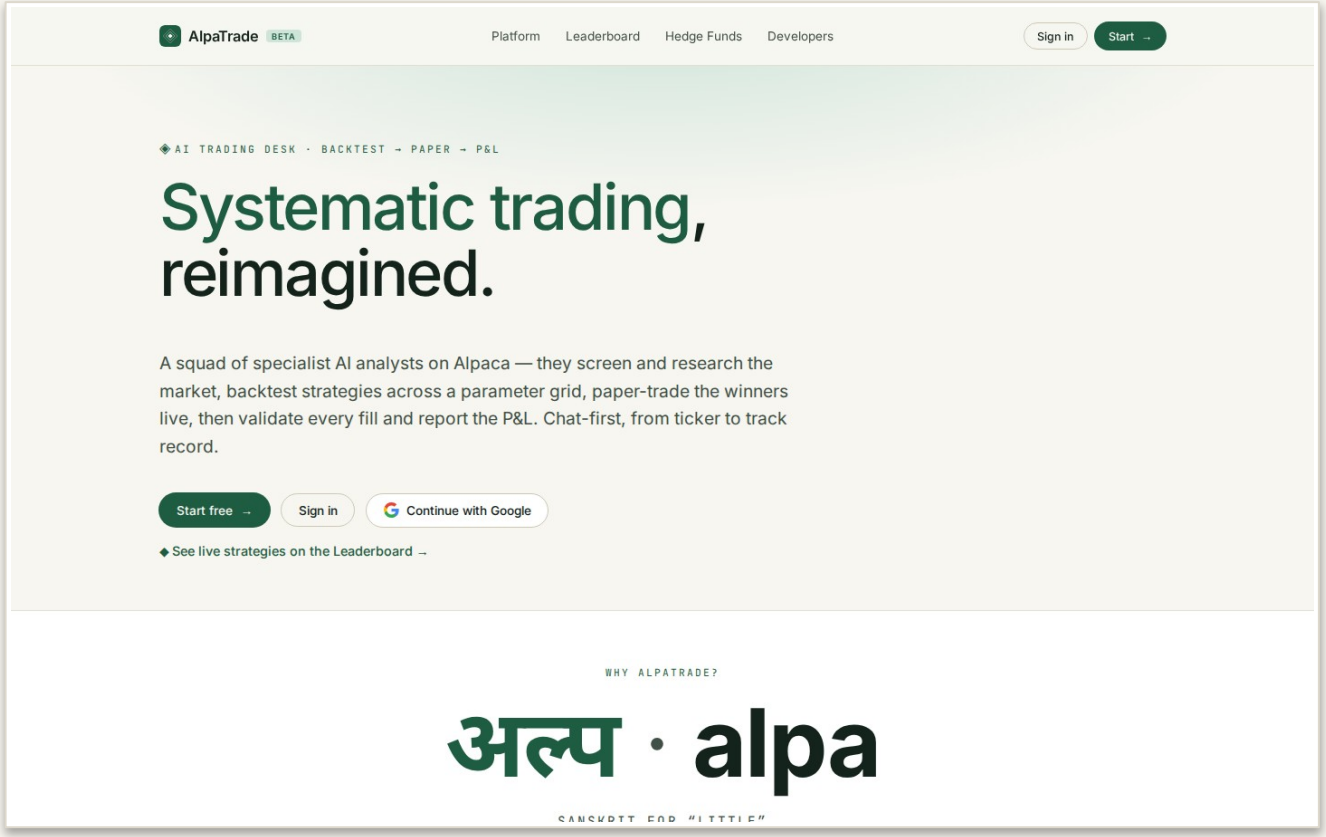
AlpaTrade user guide

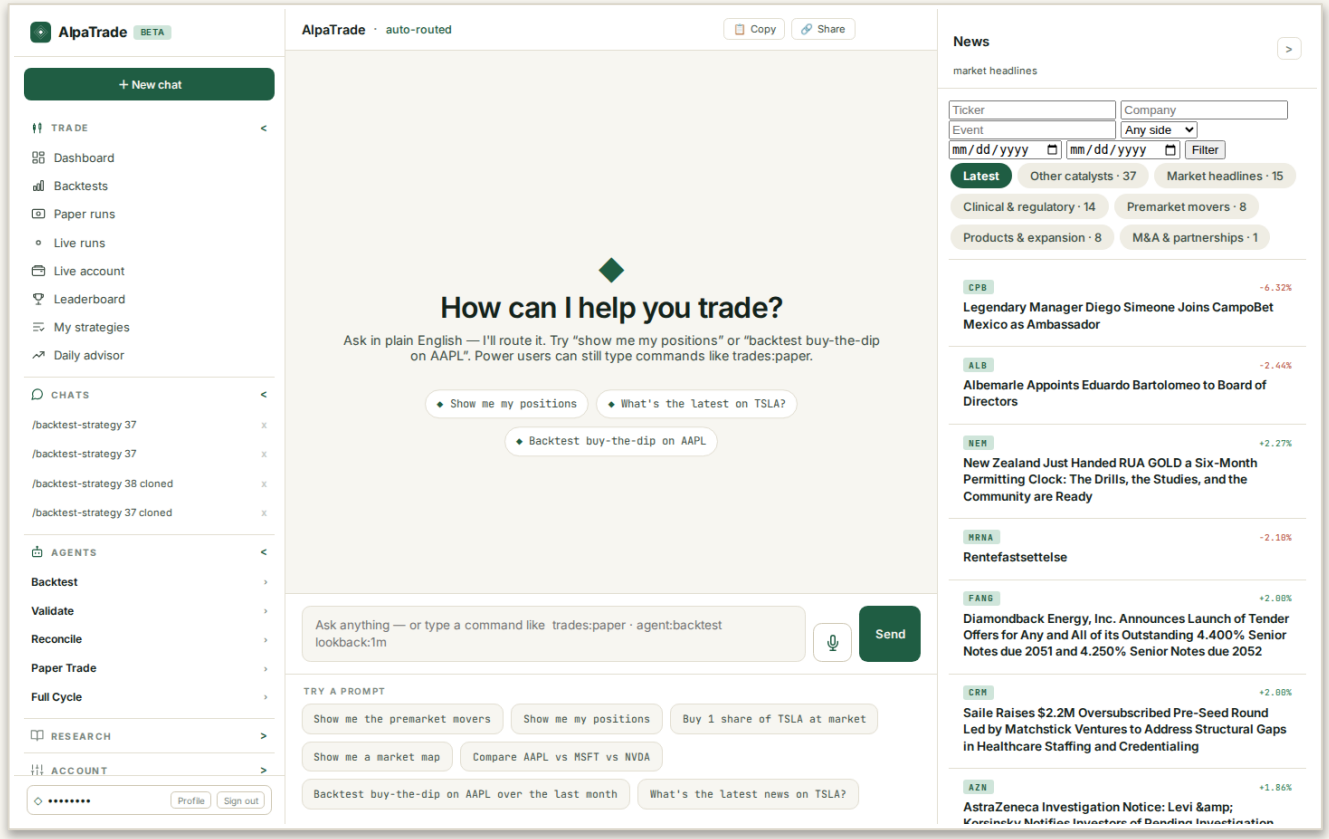
The chat-first AI trading desk on Alpaca, from sign-in to your first live strategy

- Part 1 · Getting started: sign in, connect Alpaca from the chat, clone the Mag-7 buy-the-dip strategy, backtest it and activate it
- Part 2 · Advanced features: every other menu, from the Leaderboard and Hedge Funds to the Dashboard, Settings, News and Profile
- Version 0.40.1 · 12 October 2026 · Predictive Labs Ltd



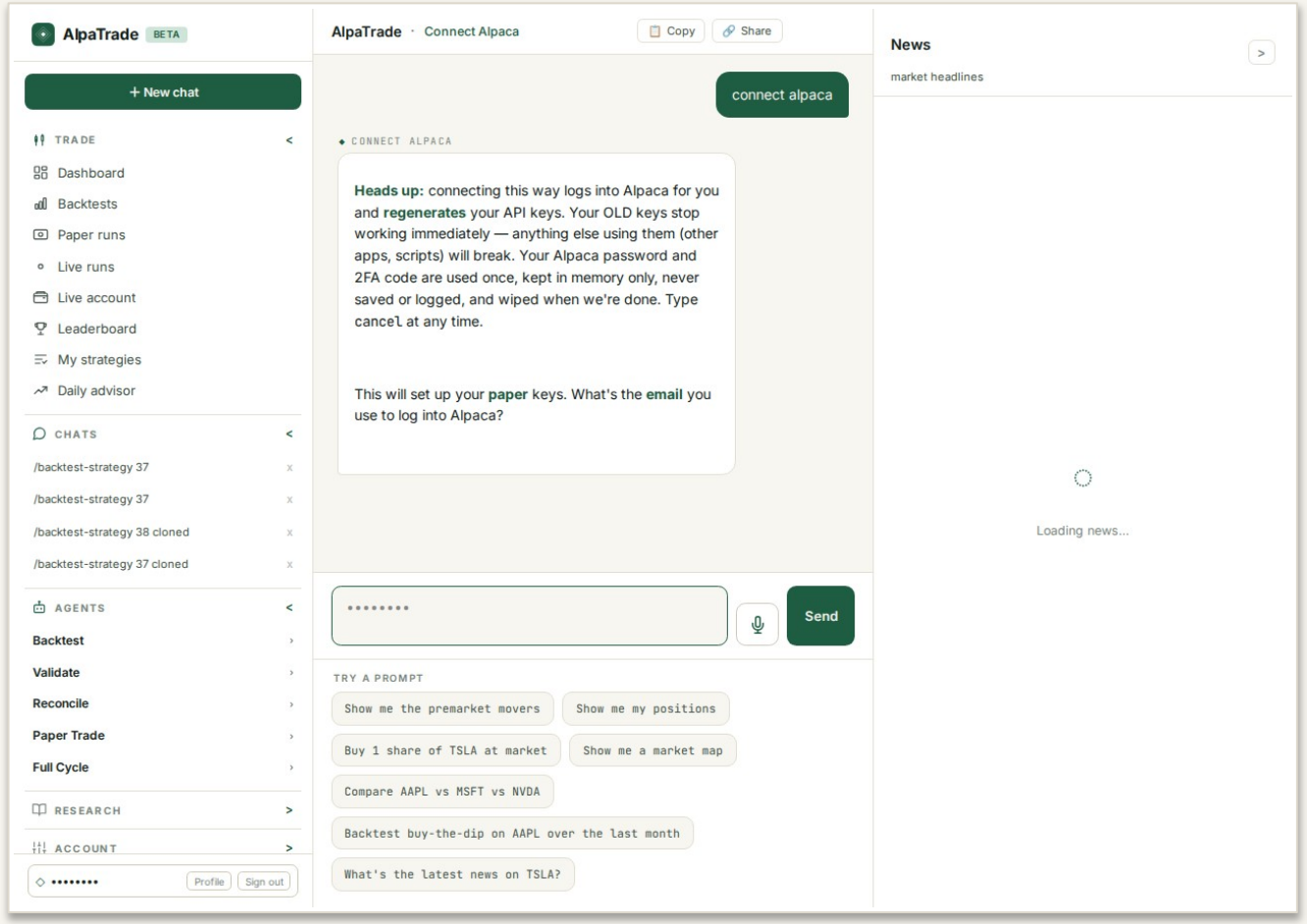
1. Sign in and open the chat

- Go to alpatrade.chat and choose Sign in, or Start to create a free account.
- Sign in with Google, or with your email and password.
- You land in the chat. The left menu holds Trade, Chats, Agents, Research and Account. Market news is on the right.
- Type a request in plain English, or tap one of the Try a prompt ideas below the box.



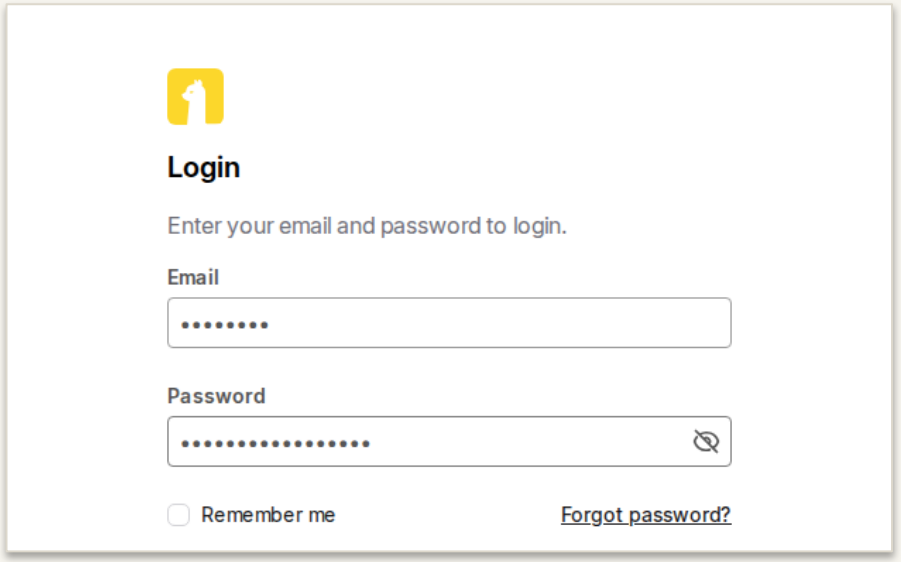
2. Connect Alpaca from the chat

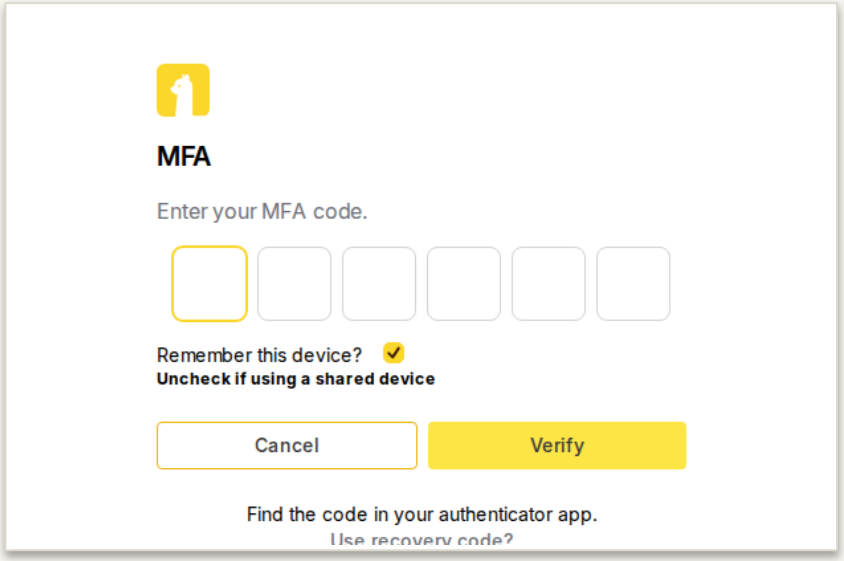
- In the chat box, type connect alpaca. Type connect alpaca live to set up your live keys as well.
- Read the heads-up first. AlpaTrade logs in to Alpaca for you and creates new API keys, so your old keys stop working at once.
- Enter the email you use for Alpaca, then your Alpaca password. The box hides what you type. The password is used once and never saved.
- Type cancel at any time to stop.



You only type the 2FA code

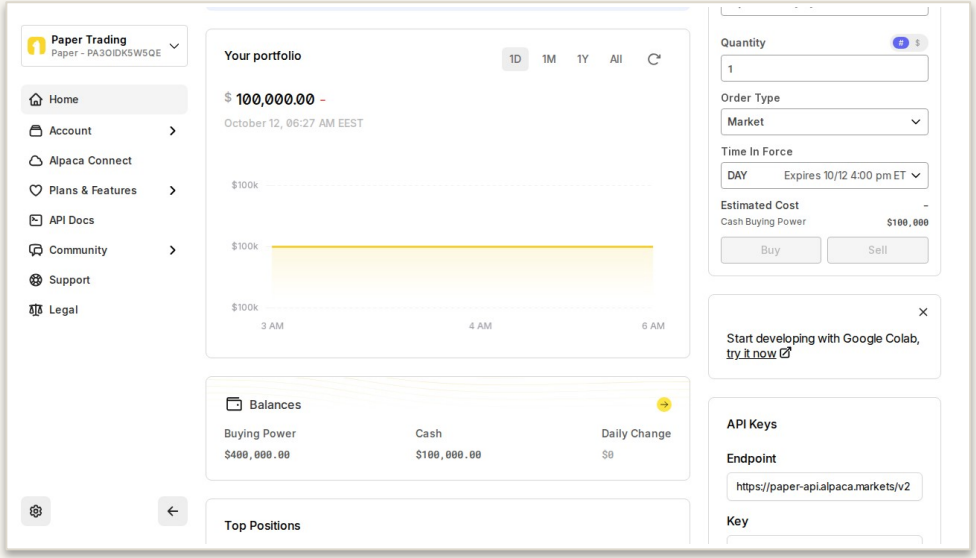
- AlpaTrade opens Alpaca's login page in a secure browser on its server and fills in your email and password for you (masked in these pictures).
- Alpaca then asks for the 6-digit code from your authenticator app.
- Type that code into the AlpaTrade chat straight away, because codes expire in about 30 seconds. It is hidden and never stored.
- You don't open Alpaca yourself. The 2FA code is the only thing you type.

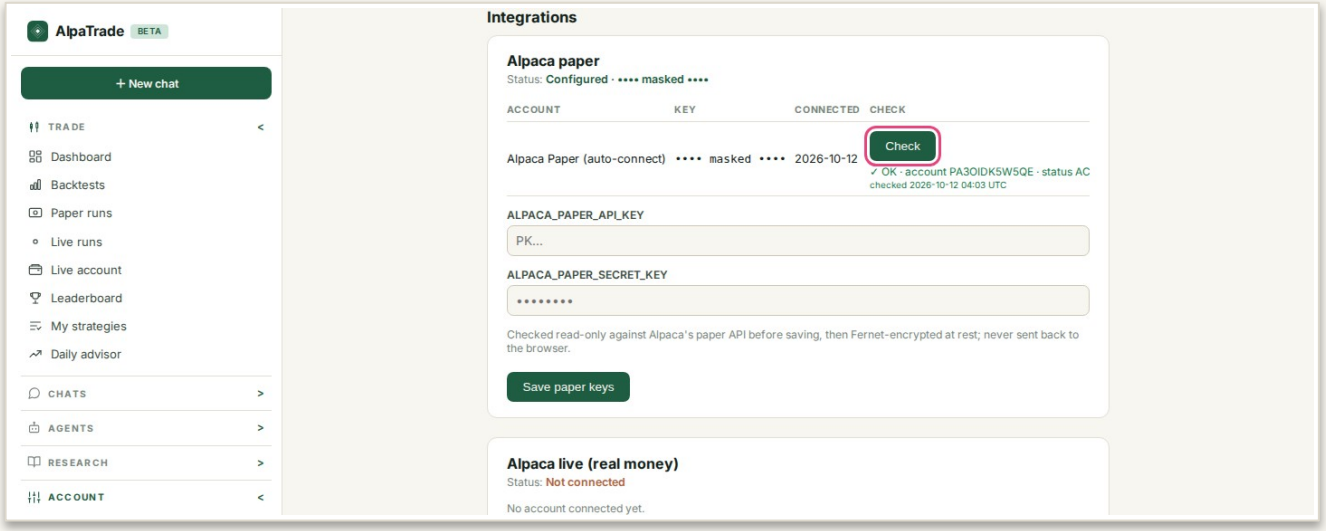




New keys created, saved and checked

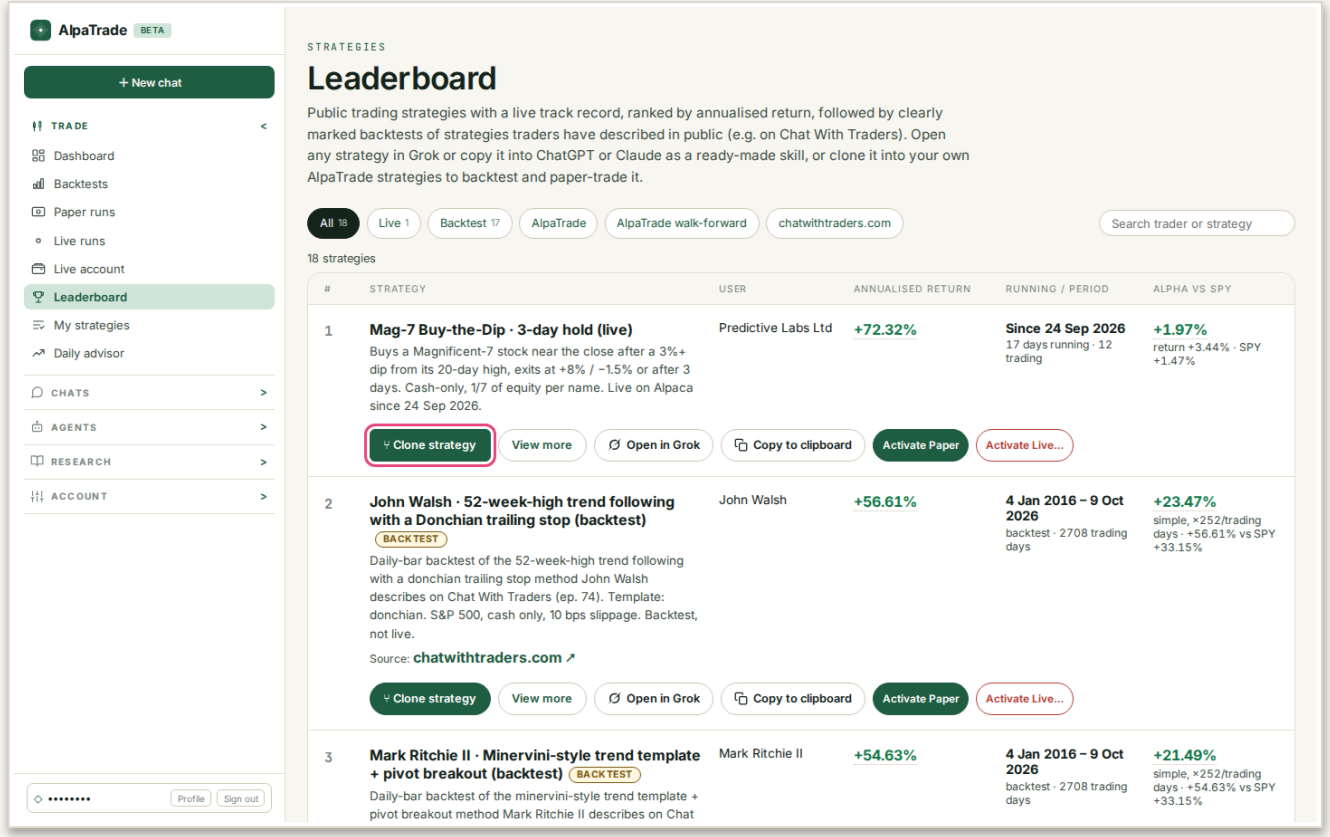
- AlpaTrade creates a fresh paper key pair on your Alpaca dashboard. The key and secret are masked here.
- The keys are checked read-only with Alpaca and then stored encrypted. The secret is never sent back to your browser.
- The chat confirms: Done! Alpaca is connected.
- Settings > Integrations now shows Alpaca paper as Configured. Press Check at any time: a green OK shows your account and its status.
- Prefer to do it by hand? Paste your keys into the same Settings form.





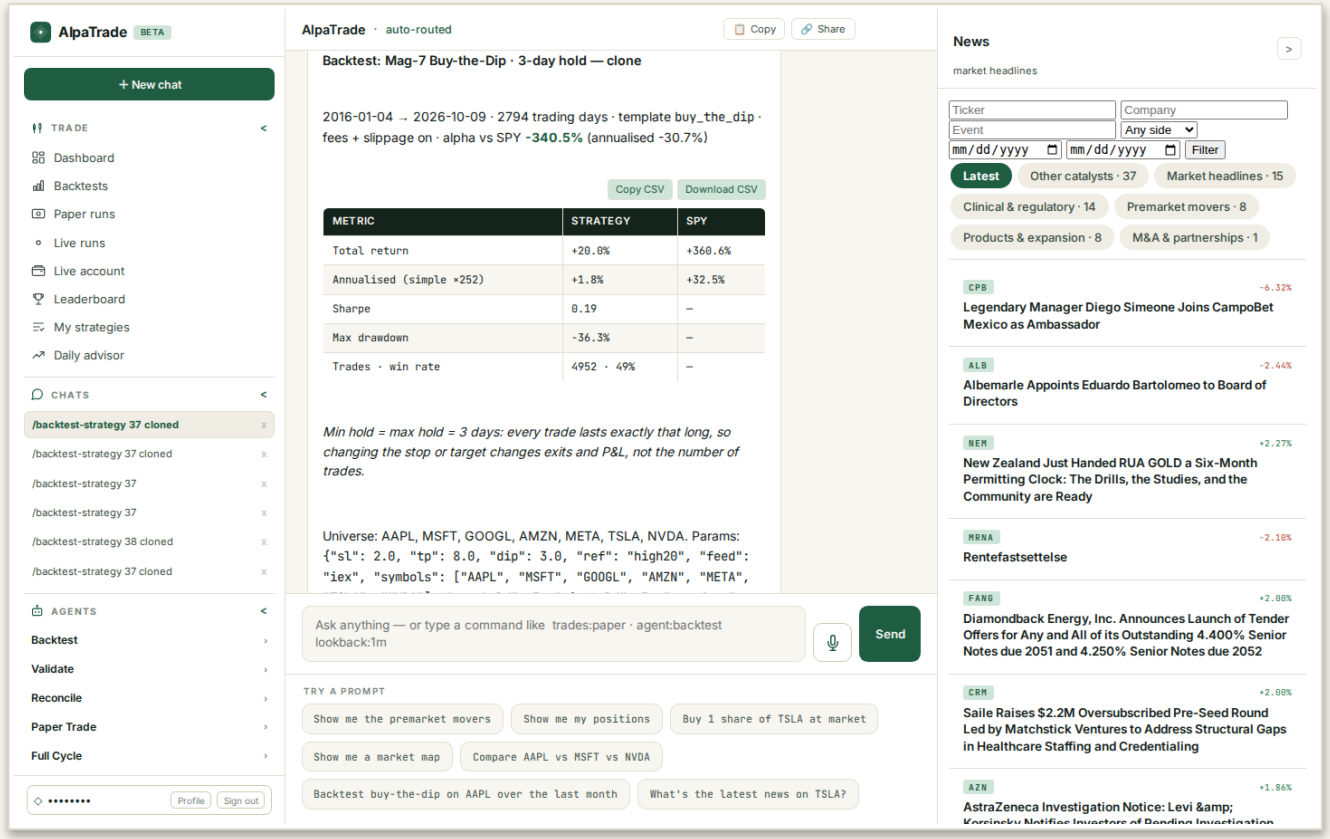
3. Pick Mag-7 Buy-the-Dip and clone it

- Open Leaderboard from the left menu.
- Mag-7 Buy-the-Dip · 3-day hold (live) is the live strategy run by Predictive Labs Ltd. It buys a Magnificent-7 stock after a dip of 3% or more from its 20-day high. It sells at +8%, at −1.5% or after 3 days.
- Each row shows the annualised return, how long the strategy has run, and its alpha vs SPY.
- Press Clone strategy. You get your own private copy, and a backtest starts in a new chat. If you clone the same strategy again, AlpaTrade reuses your copy.



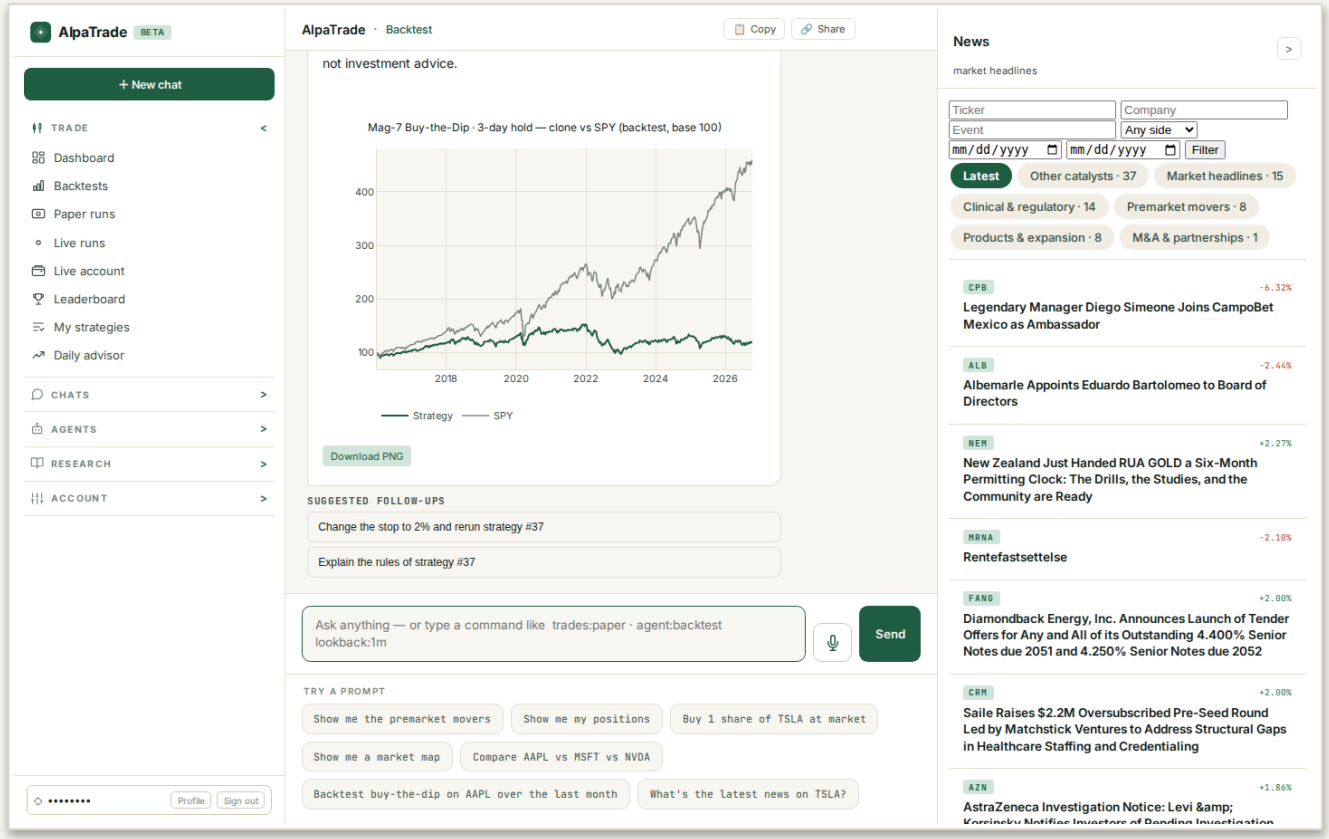
4. Backtest your copy in the chat

- The backtest uses daily data from January 2016 to today, with fees and slippage included.
- The table compares your strategy with SPY: total return, annualised return, Sharpe ratio, maximum drawdown, number of trades and win rate.
- In this run the strategy made +20.0% in total (+1.8% a year), against +360.6% for SPY. Sharpe was 0.19, the worst drawdown −36.3%, with 4,952 trades and 49% of them winners.
- Copy CSV and Download CSV export the figures.
- A backtest is hypothetical. It is not investment advice.



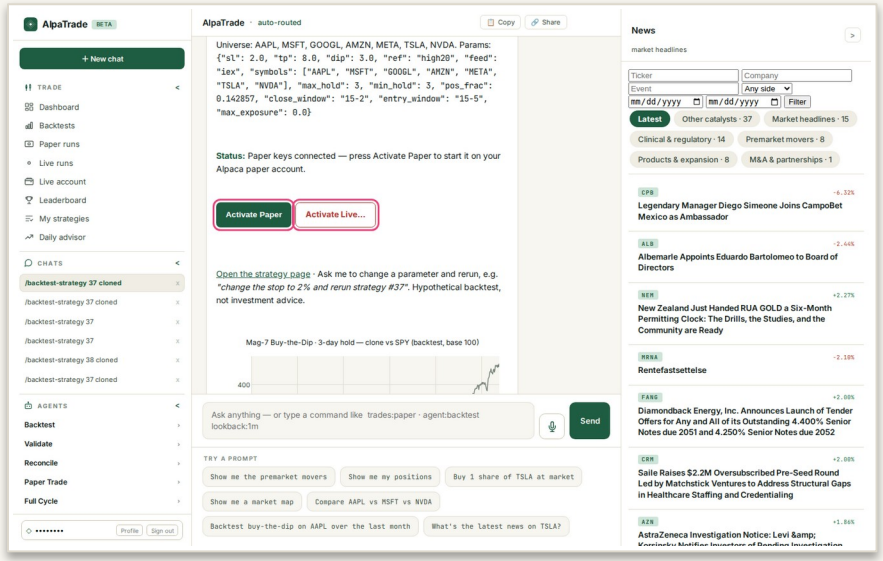
The equity curve vs SPY

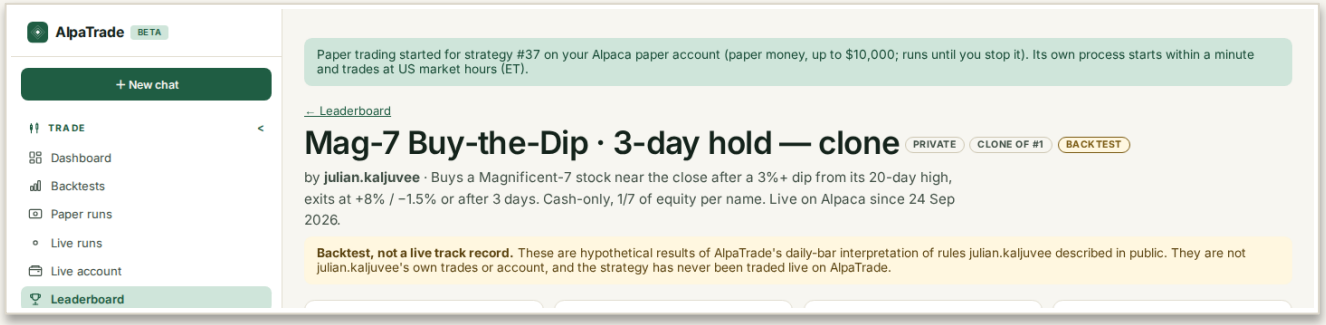
- Below the table, a chart shows your strategy and SPY. Both lines start at 100.
- Download PNG saves the chart.
- To try a change, ask in plain English, for example: change the stop to 2% and rerun strategy #37. You can also tap a suggested follow-up.
- Open the strategy page to read the full rules or to rerun the backtest.



5. Activate on paper or live

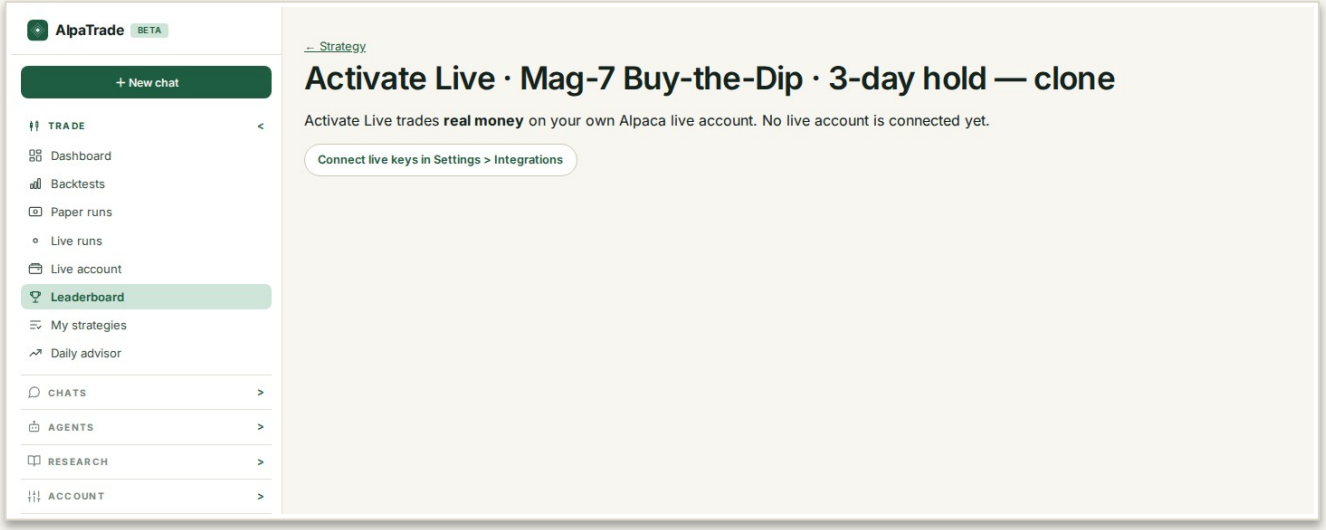
- Under the backtest, the chat shows your status and two buttons.
- Activate Paper trades with paper money (up to $10,000) on your Alpaca paper account until you stop it. It starts within a minute and trades during US market hours (ET).
- Activate Live… always opens a confirmation page first. One click never starts live trading.
- The same buttons appear on the Leaderboard and under My strategies.





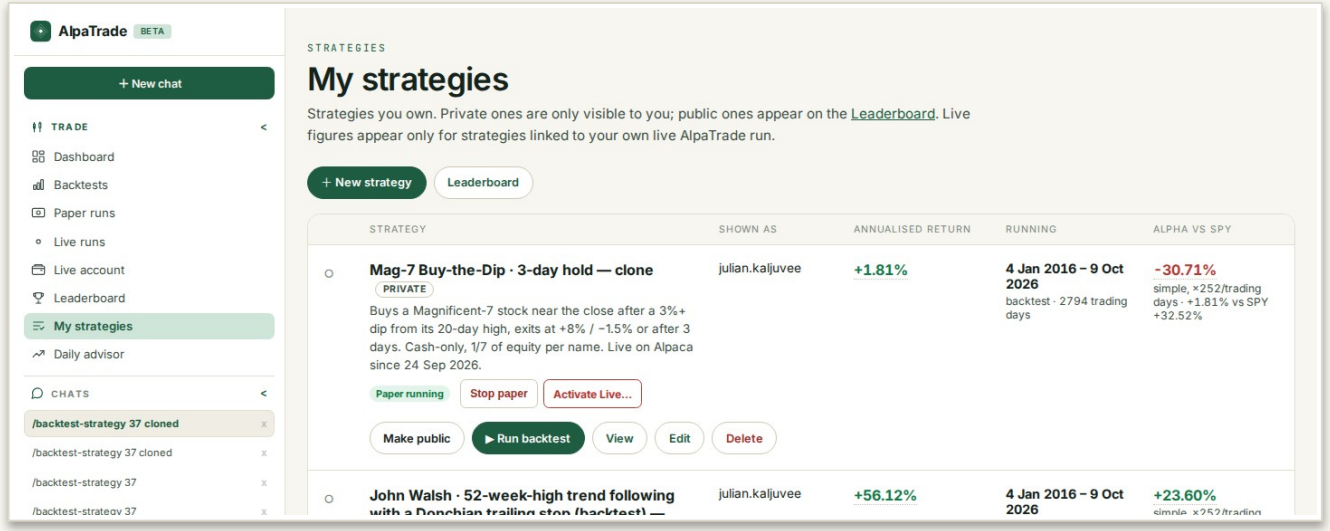
Activate Live: you confirm first

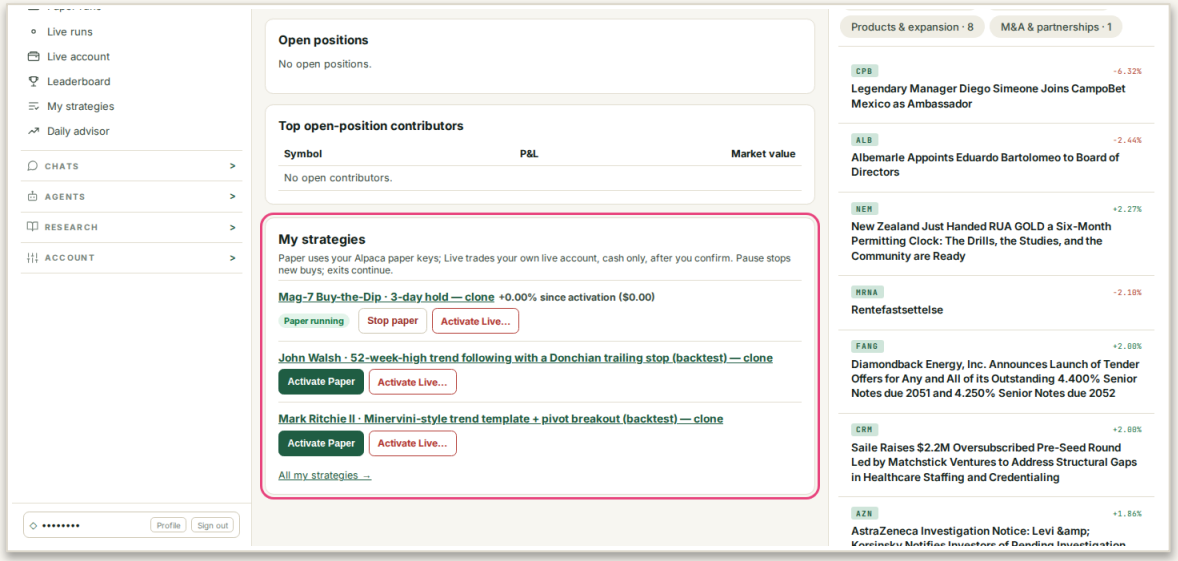
- Activate Live trades real money on your own Alpaca live account, using cash only.
- If no live account is connected, you see this page. Follow the link to Settings > Integrations, or type connect alpaca live in the chat.
- With a live account connected, the page shows the amount the strategy may use and asks you to confirm. The strategy starts only after you confirm.
- Later you can Pause it (no new buys; open trades still exit) or Deactivate it.



My strategies and the Dashboard card

- My strategies lists every strategy you own, private ones included, with Shown as, annualised return, running period and alpha vs SPY.
- A strategy that is trading shows Paper running, with a Stop paper button next to it.
- The Dashboard has a My strategies card with the same controls and the return since you activated it.
- Make public lists your strategy on the Leaderboard. Edit and Delete sit beside it.

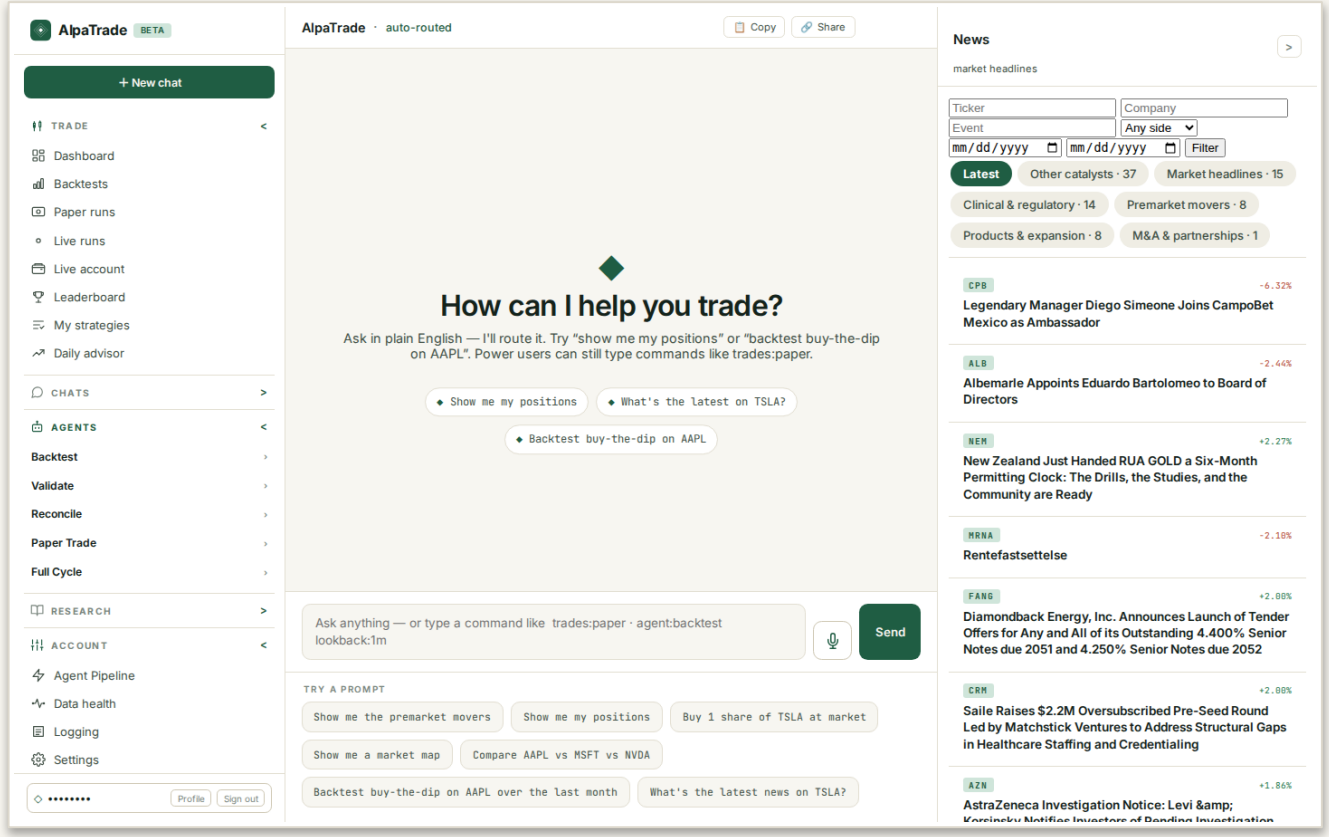




Part 2 · Advanced features

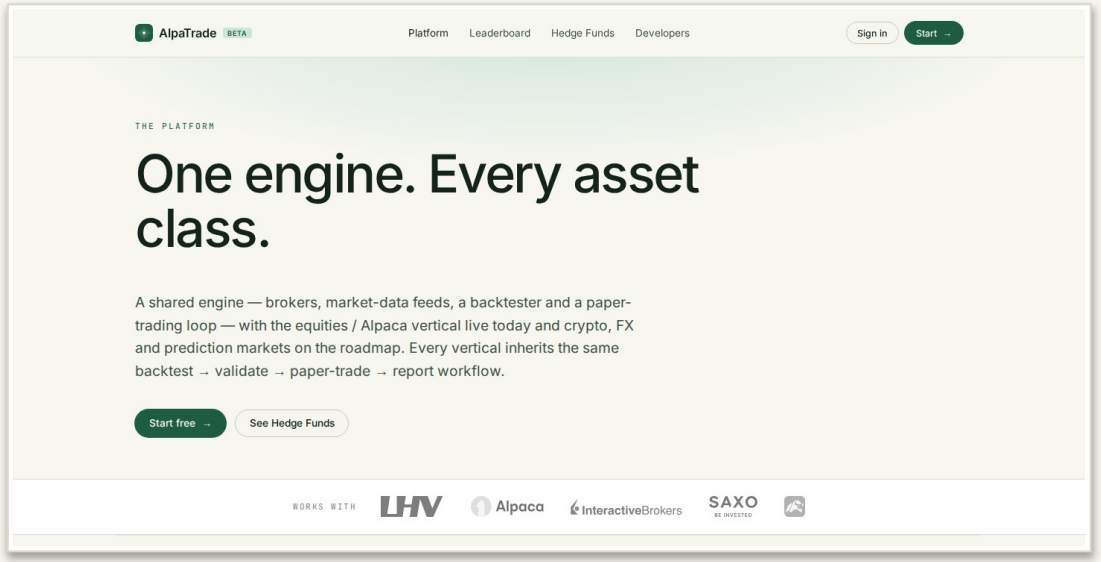
Everything beyond your first strategy

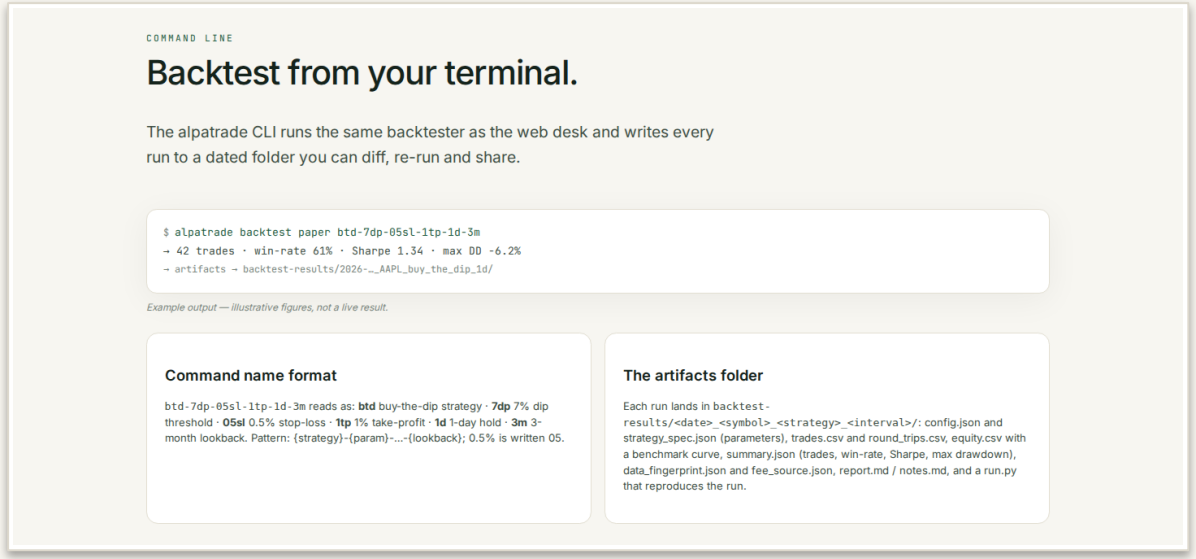
- Public site: Platform, Leaderboard, Hedge Funds and Developers.
- Trade: Dashboard, Backtests, Paper runs, Live runs, Live account, Leaderboard, My strategies and Daily advisor.
- Agents: Backtest, Validate, Reconcile, Paper Trade and Full Cycle.
- Research: Market Map, Charts, Premarket, Model Analytics, News, Hedge Funds and more.
- Account: Agent Pipeline, Data health, Logging, Settings and Help. Profile is at the bottom of the menu.



Platform and Developers

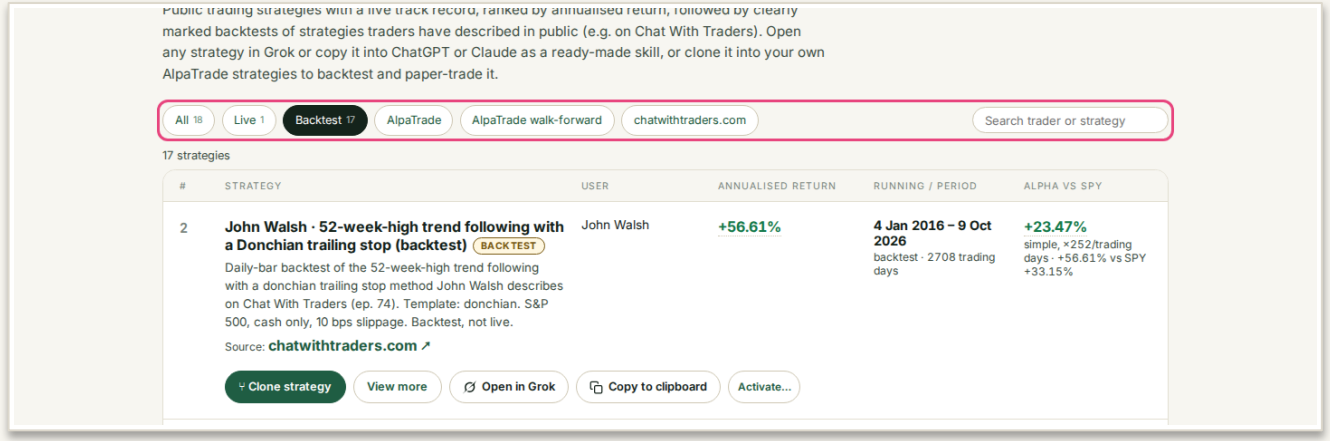
- Platform explains the engine behind AlpaTrade: broker links, market data, a backtester and a paper-trading loop.
- US equities on Alpaca are live today. Crypto, FX and prediction markets are on the roadmap.
- Developers documents the Agent API at api.alpatrade.chat, with an API reference and a Swagger page to try calls.
- Command line: alpatrade backtest paper btd-7dp-05sl-1tp-1d-3m runs the same backtester from your terminal. The name spells out the settings, and each run saves a dated results folder.

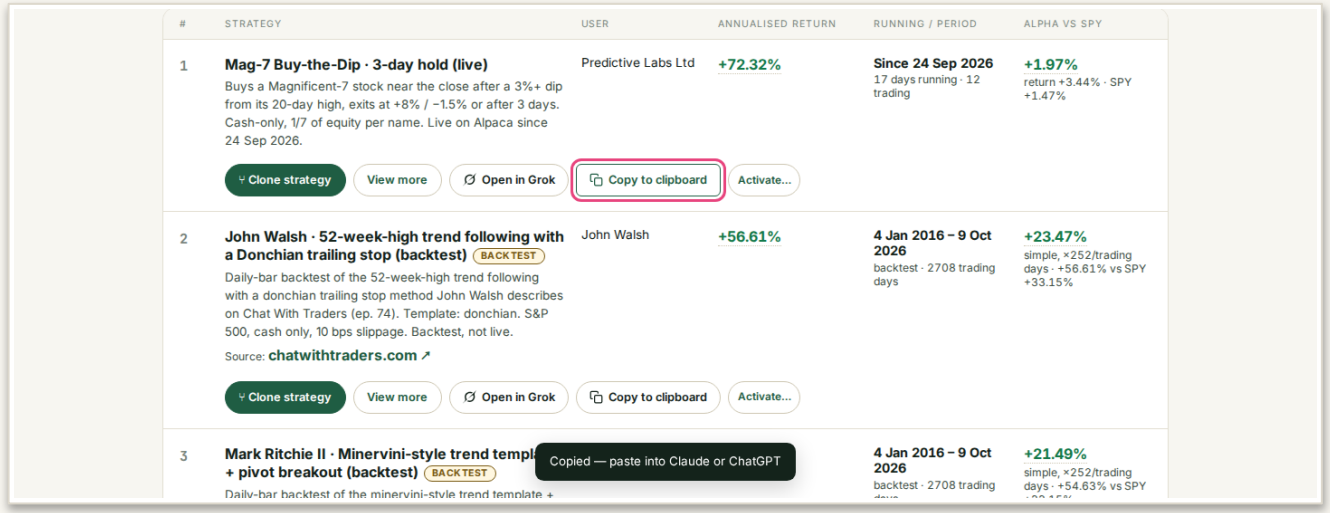




Leaderboard filters and Copy for ChatGPT / Claude

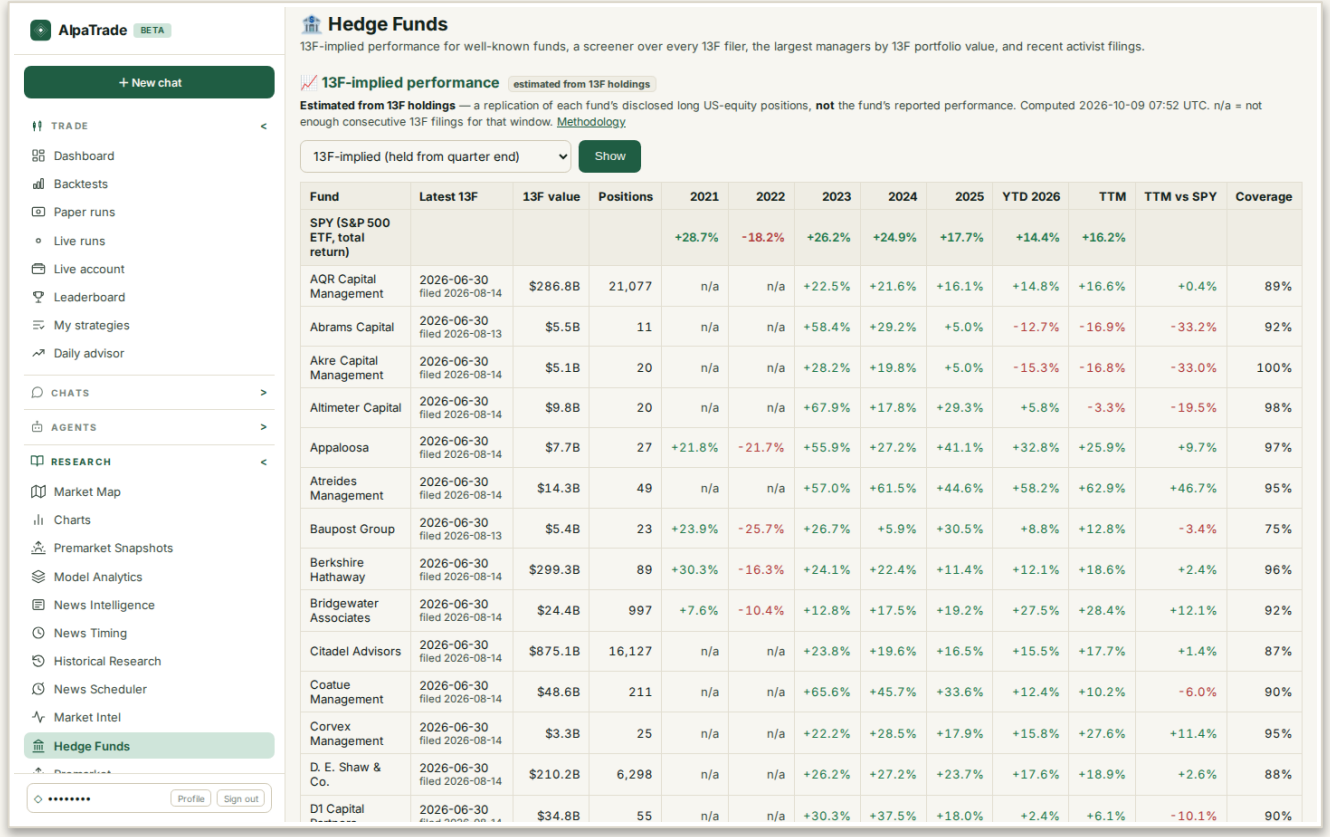
- Filter by All, Live, Backtest, AlpaTrade, AlpaTrade walk-forward or chatwithtraders.com, or search for a trader or strategy.
- Backtests carry a BACKTEST label. Only Live entries show a real track record.
- Open in Grok opens the strategy in Grok, ready to discuss.
- Copy to clipboard copies the strategy as a ready-made skill. Paste it into ChatGPT or Claude.
- View more opens the full strategy page.





Hedge Funds

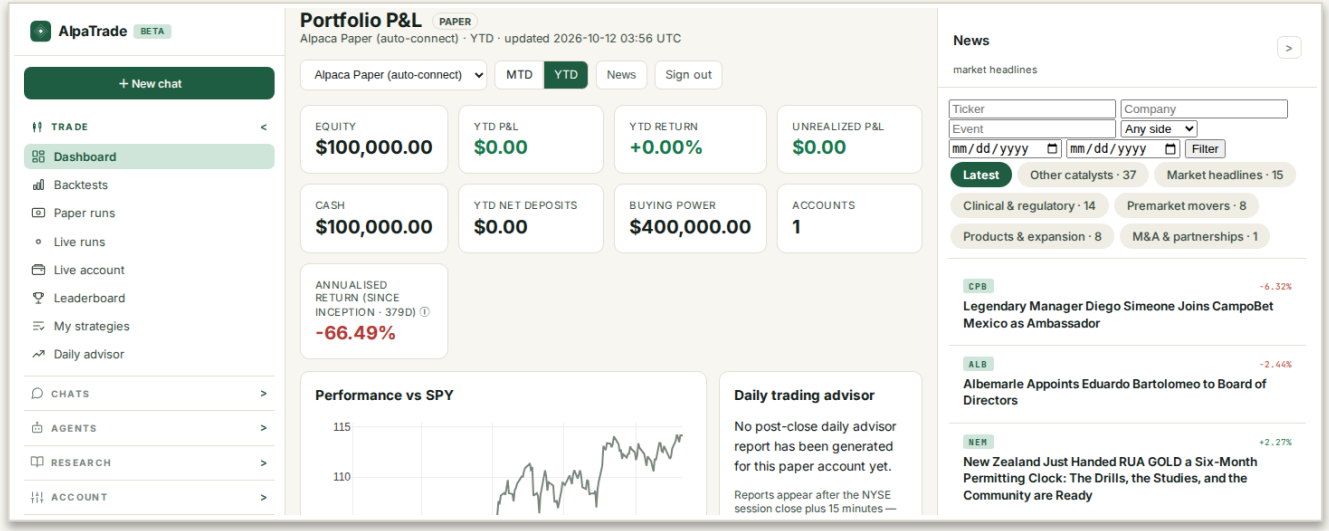
- See what well-known funds hold and how that portfolio performed.
- Returns are estimated from each fund's 13F filings (its disclosed long US stock positions). They are not the fund's reported results.
- Columns show each year since 2021, year to date, the last twelve months, the last twelve months vs SPY, and coverage.
- There is also a screener over every 13F filer, the largest managers and recent activist filings. Free for everyone once signed in.

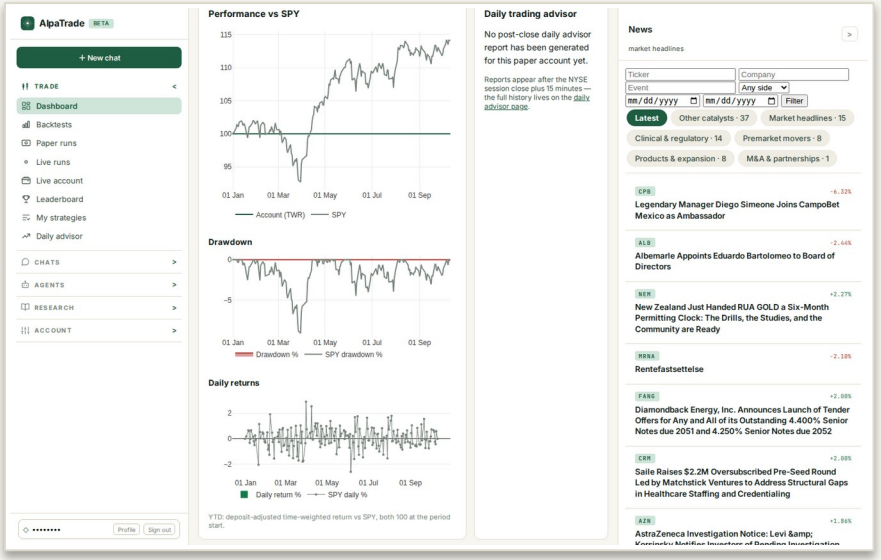


Fund	Latest 13F	13F value	Positions	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	YTD 2026	TTM	TTM vs SPY	Coverage
SPY (S&P 500 ETF, total return)				+28.7%	-18.2%	+26.2%	+24.9%	+17.7%	+14.4%	+16.2%		
AQR Capital Management	2026-06-30 filed 2026-08-14	$286.8B	21,077	n/a	n/a	+22.5%	+21.6%	+16.1%	+14.8%	+16.6%	+0.4%	89%
Abrams Capital	2026-06-30 filed 2026-08-13	$5.5B	11	n/a	n/a	+58.4%	+29.2%	+5.0%	-12.7%	-16.9%	-33.2%	92%
Akre Capital Management	2026-06-30 filed 2026-08-14	$5.1B	20	n/a	n/a	+28.2%	+19.8%	+5.0%	-15.3%	-16.8%	-33.0%	100%
Altimeter Capital	2026-06-30 filed 2026-08-14	$9.8B	20	n/a	n/a	+67.9%	+17.8%	+29.3%	+5.8%	-3.3%	-19.5%	98%
Appaloosa	2026-06-30 filed 2026-08-14	$7.7B	27	+21.8%	-21.7%	+55.9%	+27.2%	+41.1%	+32.8%	+25.9%	+9.7%	97%
Atreides Management	2026-06-30 filed 2026-08-14	$14.3B	49	n/a	n/a	+57.0%	+61.5%	+44.6%	+58.2%	+62.9%	+46.7%	95%
Baupost Group	2026-06-30 filed 2026-08-13	$5.4B	23	+23.9%	-25.7%	+26.7%	+5.9%	+30.5%	+8.8%	+12.8%	-3.4%	75%
Berkshire Hathaway	2026-06-30 filed 2026-08-14	$299.3B	89	+30.3%	-16.3%	+24.1%	+22.4%	+11.4%	+12.1%	+18.6%	+2.4%	96%
Bridgewater Associates	2026-06-30 filed 2026-08-14	$24.4B	997	+7.6%	-10.4%	+12.8%	+17.5%	+19.2%	+27.5%	+28.4%	+12.1%	92%
Citadel Advisors	2026-06-30 filed 2026-08-14	$875.1B	16,127	n/a	n/a	+23.8%	+19.6%	+16.5%	+15.5%	+17.7%	+1.4%	87%
Coatue Management	2026-06-30 filed 2026-08-14	$48.6B	211	n/a	n/a	+65.6%	+45.7%	+33.6%	+12.4%	+10.2%	-6.0%	90%
Corvex Management	2026-06-30 filed 2026-08-14	$3.3B	25	n/a	n/a	+22.2%	+28.5%	+17.9%	+15.8%	+27.6%	+11.4%	95%
D. E. Shaw & Co.	2026-06-30 filed 2026-08-14	$210.2B	6,298	n/a	n/a	+26.2%	+27.2%	+23.7%	+17.6%	+18.9%	+2.6%	88%
D1 Capital	2026-06-30	$34.8B	55	n/a	n/a	+30.3%	+37.5%	+18.0%	+2.4%	+6.1%	-10.1%	90%

Dashboard: paper or live, MTD or YTD

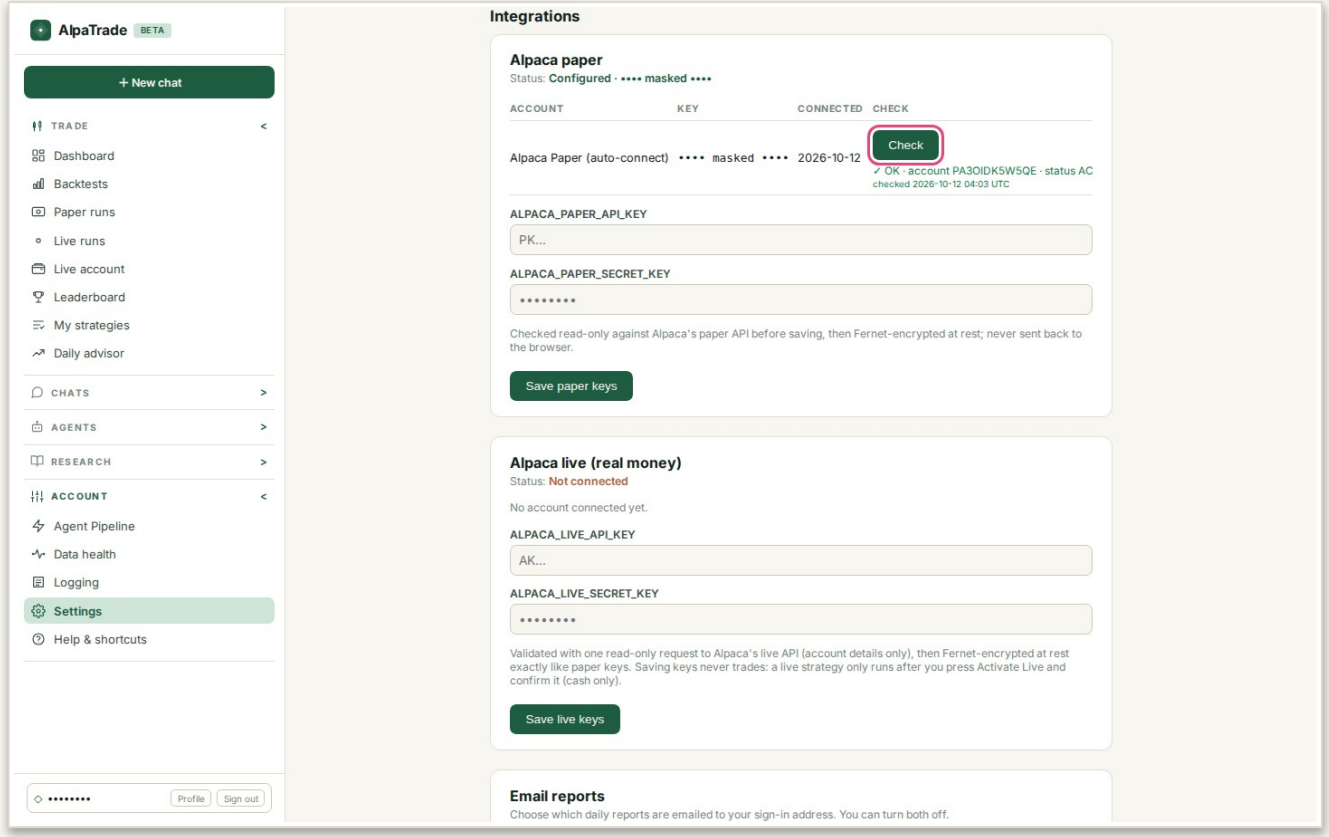
- Choose an account (all accounts, a paper account or a live account) and a period: MTD or YTD.
- Tiles show equity, P&L, return, unrealised P&L, cash, net deposits, buying power and the annualised return since the account opened.
- Three charts: Performance vs SPY (both start at 100), Drawdown, and Daily returns vs SPY.
- Further down: Daily trading advisor, P&L contributors, strategy rankings, open positions and My strategies.





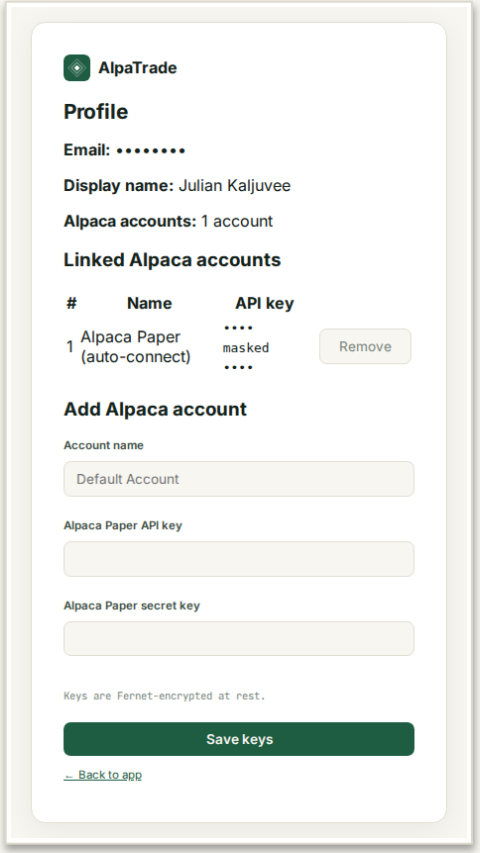
Settings > Integrations

- Alpaca paper and Alpaca live (real money) each have their own keys and status.
- Check sends one read-only request to Alpaca and shows OK with the account and its status.
- Keys are stored encrypted and never sent back to your browser. Saving keys never places a trade.
- A live strategy runs only after you press Activate Live and confirm.
- Email reports: choose which daily reports reach your sign-in address.



Profile and Shown as

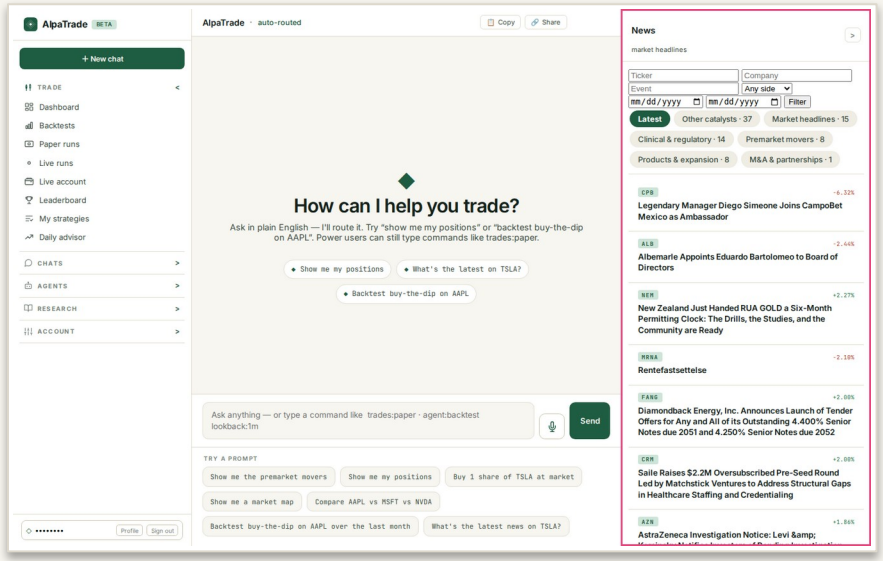
- Profile shows your email, display name and linked Alpaca accounts, with keys masked. You can add another paper account or remove one.
- Shown as is the public name on the Leaderboard and the strategy page, up to 80 characters. Set it under My strategies > Edit.
- Tick Public to list a strategy on the Leaderboard. Leave it unticked to keep the strategy private.

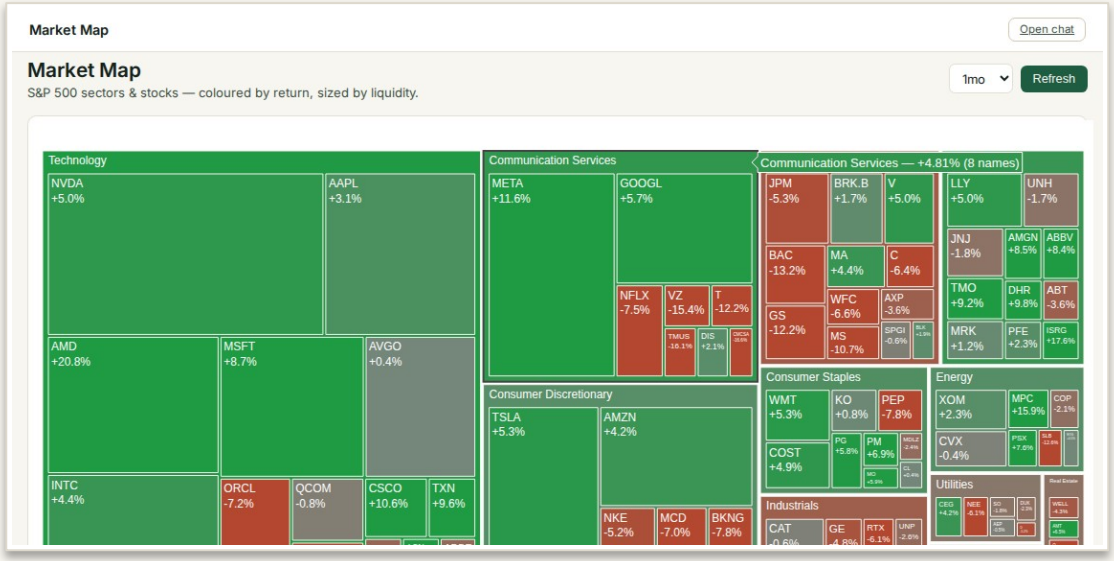




News and research

- The News panel sits to the right of the chat and the Dashboard. It shows the latest headlines with the ticker and its move, grouped by catalyst.
- Filter by ticker, company, event, direction or date. Close the panel with >.
- The Research menu adds Market Map (S&P 500 by sector, coloured by return), Charts, Premarket, Model Analytics, News Timing, Historical Research and Market Intel.
- You can also ask in the chat: What's the latest news on TSLA? or Show me a market map.





Runs, advisor, agents and help

- Backtests lists grid-searched runs that are ready to deploy. You can start from a preset such as Dip · mega-cap tech or Momentum.
- Paper runs and Live runs list your sessions. Live account is a read-only view of a linked live account.
- Daily advisor reviews your paper accounts each day, 15 minutes after the NYSE close.
- The Agents menu runs Backtest, Validate, Reconcile, Paper Trade or Full Cycle. Agent Pipeline shows the automated pipeline.
- Help & shortcuts holds the full command reference.

